

Report

**Indigenous and local knowledge
dialogue workshop**

For the

**Scoping of the second IPBES
global assessment**

Online, 5 June 2024

Suggested citation

IPBES (2024). Wilfredo Alangui, Myrle Ballard, Ramiro Batzin, Joji Cariño, Adelaido Corcino Martinez, Florence Daguitan, Kriss Davies, Sandra C.A. Ferguson, Mohamed Handaine, Guadalupe Yesenia Hernandez Marquez, Aslak Holmberg, Maui Hudson, Ramson Karmushu, Lynn Jacobs, Pius Loupa, Gathuru Mburu, Lucy Mullenkei, Gabriel Nemogá, Kamal Kumar Rai, Miri Raven, Francisco J. Rosado-May, Nick Roskruge, Ndiaga Sall, Cecilio Solís Librado, Vyacheslav Shadrin, Laitia Tamata, Prasert Trakansuphakon, Yeshing Upun, and Geronimo Vega. Report of the Indigenous and local knowledge dialogue workshop for the scoping of the second IPBES global assessment. 5 June 2024, Online.

Disclaimer

The text in section 3, represents an attempt to reflect solely the views and contributions of the participants in the dialogue. As such, it does not represent the views of IPBES or UNESCO or reflect upon their official positions.

Acknowledgements

We are very grateful to all of the participants who shared their knowledge and perspectives on the draft scoping report during the workshop. This support for IPBES and the second global assessment is very much appreciated, and is recognized as essential to the work.

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1. Introduction

This is the report of the Indigenous and local knowledge (ILK) dialogue workshop for the scoping of the second global assessment of biodiversity and ecosystem services (referred to hereafter as “the second global assessment”; for further information: <https://www.ipbes.net/second-global-assessment>), which is being developed by the Intergovernmental Science-Policy Platform on Biodiversity and Ecosystems Services (IPBES). The workshop was held online on 5 June 2024, in two sessions to suit different time zones. The workshop provided a platform for members of Indigenous Peoples and local communities to discuss the assessment’s draft scoping report, which had been prepared prior to the workshop. The workshop took place within the external review period of the scoping report, which ran from 29 May 2024 to 25 June 2024.

This report aims to provide a written record of the dialogue workshop, which can be used as a resource by scoping report authors, and eventually authors of the assessment itself. It is also intended as a resource for all dialogue participants and others who may wish to review and contribute to the work of the second global assessment moving forward.

The report is not intended to be comprehensive or give final resolution to the many interesting discussions and debates that took place during the workshop. Instead, it is intended as a written record of the discussions, and this conversation will continue to evolve. For this reason, both clear points of agreement and diverging views among participants are presented for further attention and discussion.

The text in section 3 represents an attempt to reflect solely the views and contributions of the participants in the dialogue. As such, it does not represent the views of IPBES or UNESCO or reflect upon their official positions.

The agenda and participants’ list for the dialogue are provided in annexes 1 and 3.

2. Background

2.1. IPBES

IPBES is an independent intergovernmental body established to strengthen the science-policy interface for biodiversity and ecosystem services for the conservation and sustainable use of biodiversity, long-term human well-being and sustainable development.

2.1.1. IPBES and Indigenous and local knowledge

Since its inception in 2012, IPBES has recognized that Indigenous Peoples and local communities possess detailed knowledge of biodiversity and ecosystem trends. In its first work programme (2014-2018), IPBES built on this recognition through deliverable 1 (c), *Procedures, approaches, and participatory processes for working with Indigenous and local knowledge systems*. The IPBES rolling work programme up to 2030 includes objective 3 (b), *Enhanced recognition of and work with Indigenous and local knowledge systems*, which aims to further this work.

Recognizing the importance of ILK to the conservation and sustainable use of biodiversity as a cross-cutting issue relevant to all of its activities, and noting also that approaches and methods for working with ILK and Indigenous Peoples and local communities in global and regional scale assessments would need to be developed, the IPBES Plenary¹ established a [task force on Indigenous and local knowledge systems](#) and agreed on [terms of reference](#) guiding its operations towards implementing this deliverable. The work of IPBES with Indigenous Peoples and local communities and on ILK is supported by a technical support unit for ILK, hosted by UNESCO.

Key activities and deliverables of the task force and technical support unit on ILK so far include:

- Progress in the development of approaches and methodologies for working with ILK was made during previous IPBES assessments (Pollination, Pollinators and Food Production, Land Degradation and Restoration, four Regional Assessments and a Global Assessment of Biodiversity and Ecosystem Services, Sustainable Use of Wild Species, Diverse Values and Valuation of Nature and Invasive Alien Species and their Control);
- The development and implementation of the “[approach to recognizing and working with ILK in IPBES](#)”, which was formally approved by the Plenary at its fifth session in 2017 in decision IPBES-5/1, which sets out principles and approaches for the work of IPBES with ILK;

¹ The IPBES Plenary is the body through which states that are members of IPBES take decisions. It usually meets around once a year.

- Development and implementation of methodological guidance for recognizing and working with ILK in IPBES, which aims to provide further detail and guidelines on how to work with ILK within the context of IPBES; and
- Development and implementation of a “[participatory mechanism](#)”, a series of activities and pathways to facilitate the participation of Indigenous Peoples and local communities in IPBES assessments and other activities.

2.2. The second global assessment of biodiversity and ecosystem services

2.2.1. Introduction

At the tenth IPBES Plenary session in 2023, the Member States of IPBES approved a scoping process based on an initial scoping report for the second global assessment (available [here](#)). The aim of the scoping process is to produce a full scoping report for consideration by the Plenary at its eleventh session in December 2024.

The scoping process included a call for nominations for experts who could contribute to the development of the full scoping report. These authors met at a workshop in Monaco in April 2024, and from this workshop a draft of the scoping report was produced. This was then open for external review from 29 May 2024 to 25 June 2024, with the aim of receiving comments from governments, stakeholders and Indigenous Peoples and local communities.

The online ILK dialogue workshop described in this report was held during this period. From the dialogue workshop a series of comments were developed that were submitted into the external review process, following verification from participants. The authors of the scoping report then revised the scoping report based on all comments received.

Pending approval of the scoping report, the second global assessment is planned to commence in 2025, and it would be completed in 2028.

2.2.2. Objectives of the second global assessment

The initial scoping report outlined the following objectives for the second global assessment:

(a) Support Governments and stakeholders in implementing the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) and its protocols, the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework and the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, with a view to achieving the 2050 Vision for Biodiversity and the Sustainable Development Goals, as well as the Paris Agreement adopted under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (for matters related to the links between biodiversity and climate change);

(b) Support the assessment of progress towards the achievement of the 2030 targets and 2050 goals of the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework, as well as relevant Sustainable Development Goals and targets; and

(c) Provide the scientific and technical basis for the follow-up to the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework after 2030.

2.2.3. Scope

The initial scoping report suggests that the second global assessment would be comprehensive and broadly similar in scope to the first Global Assessment while building on it to avoid repetition or unnecessary duplication, and would address all aspects of the goals, targets and other elements of the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework. The assessment would cover terrestrial and inland water ecosystems and place major emphasis on marine ecosystems, including the open ocean, coastal areas, tidal zones and seabed.

The second global assessment would address all elements of the IPBES conceptual framework and the interlinkages between them. It would incorporate diverse values and multiple worldviews, taking into account, among other things, the Methodological Assessment Report on the Diverse Values and Valuation of Nature. In particular, it would address the understanding of “living well in balance and harmony with Mother Earth and living in harmony with nature”. It would assess how to advance a holistic understanding of different worldviews and knowledge systems, as well as methods for achieving harmonic relationships between societies and nature.

2.3. Context for the dialogue workshop

The scoping process included a call for nominations for experts who could contribute to the development of a full scoping report. These authors met at a workshop in Monaco in April 2024, and from this workshop a full draft scoping report was produced. This was then open for external review from 29 May 2024 to 25 June 2024, with the aim of receiving comments from governments, stakeholders and Indigenous Peoples and local communities.

The online ILK dialogue workshop was held during this period, and from the dialogue workshop a series of comments were developed that were submitted into the external review process, following verification from participants. The authors of the scoping report then revised the scoping report based on all comments received.

Following this, the draft scoping report will be discussed by the IPBES Plenary at its eleventh session in December 2025. The Plenary will consider the scoping report and decide on the start of the assessment.

2.4. Objectives of the dialogue workshop on Indigenous and local knowledge

The objectives of the ILK dialogue workshop were as follows:

- Reviewing the draft scoping report of the second global assessment, for strengths, weaknesses, gaps and ways forward to reflect ILK and the visions, strengths and challenges of Indigenous Peoples and local communities;
- Exploring the themes and topics that Indigenous Peoples and local communities want to see in a second global assessment, including by discussing the strengths, benefits, gaps and weaknesses of previous IPBES assessments;
- Discussing the proposed structure of the assessment as laid out in the scoping report, and the methods and other related considerations for work with ILK within the proposed structure; and
- Developing a series of comments from Indigenous Peoples and local communities that can be entered into the scoping report's formal external review process.

2.5. Free, prior and informed consent

Free, prior and informed consent (FPIC) principles are central to the work of IPBES with Indigenous Peoples and local communities, and a series of ethical principles have been developed to ensure that FPIC is followed in IPBES activities. These principles were agreed upon by the participants of the dialogue, and will be followed by participants from Indigenous Peoples and local communities, the assessment authors group and the technical support unit. The full agreed-upon text and the names of those agreeing to these principles are provided in annexes 2 and 3 to this report.

2.6. Benefits to Indigenous Peoples and local communities of participating in the assessments and other activities

During previous workshops, participants discussed the need for clear benefits to Indigenous Peoples and local communities from participating in an assessment process. It was noted that IPBES does not benefit financially from its processes or products, and that the main products of IPBES are publicly available resources, including the assessments, which aim to provide free and reliable information for policymakers, decision-makers and actors at all levels, including Indigenous Peoples and local communities. Key benefits of participating in dialogue workshops,

and the assessment process as a whole, for Indigenous Peoples and local communities that were discussed included:

- The opportunity for Indigenous Peoples and local communities to share experiences with other Indigenous Peoples and local communities around the world;
- The opportunity for Indigenous Peoples and local communities to share and exchange experiences and knowledge with IPBES assessment authors;
- The opportunity to bring ILK and Indigenous Peoples and local communities' concerns to the attention of policymakers and decision-makers; and
- Use of the final assessments as a tool when Indigenous Peoples and local communities are working with policymakers, decision-makers and scientists, noting that part of the planning for the final assessment includes the development of an accessible summary for Indigenous Peoples and local communities and webinars that present the results to Indigenous Peoples and local communities.

3. Key recommendations and learning from the dialogue workshop²

Over the course of the workshop, participants from Indigenous Peoples and local communities made a series of comments and recommendations for the scope of the second global assessment. From this process, a series of comments were entered into the scoping report's formal online review process for consideration and action by its authors. The section below builds on these comments provided by the participants, providing added detail and examples that were shared during the workshop. As much as possible, the text reflects what was said during the workshop by participants, with only minimal editing.

3.1. Overview of all comments

During the ILK dialogue, there was clear agreement on the importance of the proposed chapter 2 on Indigenous and local knowledge, with a focus on conceptualizations, worldviews and interrelationships with nature by Indigenous Peoples and local communities.

Participants also noted the need for clear threads and connections between chapter 2 and the rest of the assessment. They noted that at present other chapters seem to consider ILK only briefly while much of the rest is rooted in scientific worldviews and technical language. Participants suggested that there needs to be clearer guidance to ensure that the ILK conceptualizations that would be developed in chapter 2 would also frame the other chapters. Some participants noted that this could entail moving beyond the scientific framings offered by the IPBES conceptual framework.

Throughout the discussion, participants agreed that chapter 2 as outlined in the draft scoping report seems too ambitious, and some of the content could be moved into chapters 3 and 5. This would also support a clear connection between chapters and reduce overlap.

Participants further highlighted the need for a clear strategy on building an author team with the needed expertise, particularly from Indigenous Peoples and local communities. The need for mechanisms to ensure connections between chapters, including relevant expertise in all chapters

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and in the leadership of the assessment (including co-chairs and coordinating lead authors) was noted as key. It was agreed that a clear understanding needs to be developed with the IPBES member states and relevant institutions of the nominations needed.

Other key issues raised were the need to focus on rights, and on the factors currently inhibiting progress around biodiversity conservation.

3.2. Previous assessments and aspirations for the second global assessment

To begin the process of reflecting on what the second global assessment could seek to achieve, participants were asked to consider the strengths of past IPBES assessments, and the benefits that Indigenous Peoples and local communities had seen from them, as well as where there are weaknesses and gaps.

3.2.1. Strengths and benefits to Indigenous Peoples and local communities from previous assessments

Participants in the ILK dialogue emphasized the instrumental role of IPBES assessments for Indigenous Peoples and local communities and biodiversity conservation in general. They highlighted the particular importance of the work on ILK, scenarios and pathways, and expressed confidence that upcoming assessments, such as the nexus assessment, will also yield valuable findings. Previous IPBES assessments have been crucial in making the strengths and contributions of Indigenous Peoples and local communities and ILK visible, and highlighting that ILK and Indigenous Peoples and local communities should be integral to research and decision-making processes.

Participants noted that the findings of the first Global Assessment have been very positive for Indigenous Peoples and local communities' organizations' work in the CBD, especially in the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework negotiations, as it highlighted the importance of Indigenous Peoples and local communities in conservation. Participants noted that the Global Assessment also contributed to communities building their confidence in their knowledge, by demonstrating that it is a solid foundation for sustainable development.

Two examples from Thailand were given to illustrate how the findings of the Global Assessment have been applied. First, the assessment helped to highlight the benefits of the traditional rotational farming system. As a result, this system is now recognized by society and the government. Mid-level government officials, such as those in the ministries of resources and forests, have acknowledged that when compared to cash crops, the rotational farming system is much better for the environment. However, this recognition has yet to be reflected in policies.

The second example pertains to the National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan (NBSAP) for Thailand. Historically, Indigenous Peoples did not participate in discussions about the NBSAPs. However, in 2024, for the first time, the government, with support from UNDP, included Indigenous Peoples in these discussions, a development closely linked to the Global Assessment, among other favorable frameworks.

Participants suggested that the second global assessment would be an excellent opportunity to integrate findings from all previous assessments, thereby consolidating recommendations and options and further elaborating on earlier findings.

3.2.2. Challenges and gaps in previous assessments

While previous IPBES assessments have made the strengths of Indigenous Peoples and local communities and their knowledge visible, participants noted that at many levels, ILK and Indigenous Peoples and local communities are still not engaged to address the biodiversity and climate crises.

Overall, they observed that there has been low implementation of actions recommended by multiple IPBES assessments, particularly at the national level. They also noted that many researchers continue to engage with Indigenous Peoples and local communities without attention to FPIC and other safeguards to ILK, despite this being highlighted as important in IPBES assessments.

Participants stressed that IPBES findings should be integrated into policy to ensure implementation. They noted that the CBD, informed by IPBES, currently focusses on voluntary agreements, which can impact uptake and effect.

Another major challenge identified is that many Indigenous Peoples and local communities cannot access information from IPBES assessments. An instrument is needed to make this information accessible, empowering Indigenous Peoples and local communities to strengthen their knowledge and practices, and to engage with policymakers.

3.2.3. Ways forward for the second global assessment

Participants noted that knowledge has already been gathered and published about the main drivers of biodiversity loss, such as land use change, direct exploitation of species, climate change, and invasive alien species, as well as potential solutions and tools. It is also broadly recognized that current practices are not providing the necessary outcomes. Nonetheless, the participants noted that it remains necessary for the second global assessment to explore and highlight the importance of biodiversity, and the impacts of its loss.

Participants however recommended that the second global assessment should focus on an exploration and analysis of implementation gaps and their causes. This could include identifying barriers to the implementation of known solutions and understanding the apparent lack of

motivation of key stakeholders, such as governments and institutions. An in-depth analysis and scrutiny of current structures and systems and the ways that these form barriers to necessary changes is seen as equally important.

Participants highlighted a number of challenges in relation to the implementation of solutions. From their perspective, stakeholders such as governments or institutions seem to perceive a conceptual divide between sustainable development and economic development. One reason might be that many people are removed from nature and lands, limiting their ability to see how their actions are impacting nature. For example, most people would choose not to deplete food systems, but they are currently unaware of how their activities contribute to declines in wild and farmed foods. Another reason observed is that democracies seem to favour short-term visions and a desire for immediate gains, which often competes with conservation goals and efforts.

Participants noted that the transformative change assessment may address these issues. The nexus assessment could contribute by articulating that nature conservation is not just a cost but also a global benefit, and it could highlight how crucial it is to look holistically at the ways systems support each other, such as health benefits deriving from traditional diets of Indigenous Peoples and local communities. The second global assessment could synthesize and build on these findings.

Participants also recommended that the second global assessment should provide more information and analysis on the challenges faced by Indigenous Peoples and local communities, including resource extraction, dams and, importantly, violence, killings and rights violations against environmental defenders. Land tenure was also highlighted as a key issue which impacts community wellbeing and their ability to protect and manage nature.

Importantly, participants noted that through the second global assessment, IPBES has an opportunity to develop a strategy to work with and enable governments at multiple scales on biodiversity management and ILK, and to mainstream the role of Indigenous Peoples and local communities in biodiversity management.

3.3. Terminology, concepts and language

3.3.1. Indigenous Peoples and local communities

Participants of the dialogue workshop discussed the terminology around “Indigenous Peoples and local communities”, highlighting that this is currently contested. While some participants highlighted a need for a clear separation between “Indigenous Peoples” and “local communities”, others emphasized that using the two terms together, as is usual practice in IPBES, is important.

Several participants emphasized the need to recognize “Indigenous Peoples” and “local communities” as separate groups, especially in regard to rights. The UN Declaration on the Rights

of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP) provides a specific international collective rights framework for Indigenous Peoples (including territorial and resource rights and the right to self-determination). Meanwhile, rights specifically pertaining to “local communities” vary across the world, and there is no international framework. Moreover, the conflation of local communities with Indigenous Peoples can mean that groups with very different contexts and rights are treated in the same way. Participants gave examples from New Zealand, where the term “local communities” can sometimes be used to refer to euro-descendent populations, implying that they have similar rights and needs as Indigenous Peoples, which risks reducing the rights and recognition of Māori. Similarly, in some Pacific countries there are “local communities” with political ambitions, which causes issues when they are assumed to have the same continuous connection to lands and rights as Indigenous Peoples.

Many Indigenous Peoples, through various international processes, are therefore working to prevent the continued conflation of these two groups. Some participants therefore noted that a focus on “Indigenous Peoples” in the second global assessment could align its analysis with UNDRIP and provide a much-needed focus on what this declaration means for Indigenous Peoples in practice.

Some participants noted that a separation of the concepts does not mean that local communities or Afro descendent communities should not be recognized as important groups. Local communities should be included in discussions, but as a group that is distinct from Indigenous Peoples. Countries like Canada, among others, have recognized this and incorporated this distinction into their draft National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan (NBSAP). Suggestions of how to do this in practice include using a comma to separate the groups in lists, avoiding the acronym “IPLCs”, which implies homogeneity, and being cautious and precise when discussing land and territorial and other rights of local communities, as these rights do not always apply in the same way as for Indigenous Peoples.

Other participants, however, highlighted the importance of using the term “Indigenous Peoples and local communities”. In some countries, Indigenous Peoples are not officially recognized by their governments. Using the two terms together allows IPBES to be inclusive of groups who do not have official recognition, without having to define the status of recognition. Participants did, however, note that precision is needed when discussing local communities in accordance with the conceptualization of “local communities” in the IPBES methodological guidance for recognizing and working with ILK. In this guidance “local communities” are recognized for their distinctiveness from mainstream societies in terms of worldviews, knowledge systems and continuous relationships with the land. It was also noted that the CBD, where this terminology originated, refers to “local communities with traditional lifestyles contributing to biodiversity conservation”, which additionally provides an important refinement of which groups are considered to be “local communities”. Others noted that the expression “Indigenous Peoples and like-minded local communities” can be a useful way of thinking about this conceptualization, as

in this way the term can be understood to not include many groups who have worldviews and knowledge systems rooted in “western” society or relate to majority society ways of perceiving and knowing the world. Some participants therefore noted that, if properly applied, the IPBES conceptualization of “local communities” provides enough precision to discuss a diversity of groups with worldviews and knowledge systems that are distinct from “western” or mainstream societies. The second global assessment could, however, continue the work of providing and deepening this conceptual clarity around terminology, by recognizing the common threads between Indigenous Peoples and local communities within the IPBES conceptualization and by exploring what exactly is meant by “local knowledge systems”, whilst also, importantly, recognizing and exploring the distinctive rights framework of Indigenous Peoples.

It was also noted that the first Global Assessment did not provide an in-depth exploration of this diversity among “Indigenous Peoples” and “local communities”. The second global assessment could therefore explore the diversity between different groups, and also within them, including the diversity between youth, women, elders, business owners, academics and others, including their different relationships with nature and the impacts and threats they experience.

Participants also discussed the term “knowledge systems”, noting that for many Indigenous Peoples, the term “Indigenous science” is increasingly used instead of “Indigenous and local knowledge”, to recognize that Indigenous ways of knowing are equal to “western” science.

3.3.2. Language and conceptual frameworks

Participants expressed concerns about the predominance of scientific framing and concepts in the documents related to the second global assessment. Participants noted, for example, that the overall objectives given in the assessment’s initial scoping document³ state that the assessment aims to “provide the scientific and technical basis for the follow-up to the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework after 2030”, rather than focusing on multiple knowledge systems, which suggests a predominance of scientific frameworks and objectives.

Participants also discussed the importance of language and concepts used in the draft scoping report. They noted that key worldviews and concepts from Indigenous Peoples and local communities, such as relationality, extended community with plants and animals and reciprocity should be core themes throughout the assessment. At present the scoping document does not explicitly include these frameworks, which could then lead to challenges throughout the assessment for working with ILK and worldviews of Indigenous Peoples and local communities throughout the assessment.

Within this context, participants acknowledged that the IPBES conceptual framework includes terminology that aims to consider and recognize ILK, which is a positive step. The overall

³ The initial scoping report is available in annex II of document IPBES/10/10 ([here](#)).

framework, however, remains grounded in “western” ways of seeing the world, with concepts, interactions and separations that reflect a “scientific” worldview.

In this regard, participants noted that the term “biodiversity” is a non-Indigenous construct. For example, in Mexico, Indigenous Peoples found that their closest concept to “biodiversity” was “source of life that you cannot deplete because you will go against your own existence”, which reflects a holistic cosmovision. Understanding what “nature” means to Indigenous Peoples and local communities involves understanding their philosophies, values and ways of restoring and revitalizing relationships, including spiritual relationships. For example, in Yucatec Maya, the word “*kaax*” has a meaning that includes the concept of nature and beyond, covering the interconnectivity that exists between the elements of nature and people. Participants therefore asked that the second global assessment explores different ways of conceptualizing “nature” and “biodiversity”.

Another participant noted that the term “nature’s contributions to people” contributes to enforcing a separation between humans and nature, and therefore does not reflect Indigenous Peoples and local communities’ reciprocal interrelationships within nature and Mother Earth, which includes human beings as part of nature. They also noted that “nature’s contributions to people” reflects a one directional movement of “contributions”, and obscures the relationships and responsibilities of humans to nature, as conceptualized in Indigenous principles like reciprocity and relationality.

Participants also noted that the term “good quality of life” could include consideration of what diverse Indigenous Peoples and local communities conceive as a “good quality of life”, which should include cultural and spiritual dimensions that are critically important.

For example, questions such as “How do communities value nature?” or “How do Indigenous businesses impact nature?” make sense if a human-nature separation is assumed, but may not be completely understandable within worldviews of Indigenous Peoples and local communities. The second global assessment is therefore an opportunity to gather strong evidence on the distinctive ways of life of Indigenous Peoples and local communities and to explore how their worldviews and knowledge systems, including Indigenous principles, ceremonies and spirituality, shape their relationships with their land and territories and lead to conservation and sustainability. The assessment should in this context highlight the importance of Indigenous and local languages, in terms of how these conceptualise relationships within nature.

Another example given of the challenges presented by the IPBES conceptual framework was the work of Indigenous scholars and ILK experts in chapter 3 of the IPBES Values Assessment.⁴ In this chapter, scholars made good efforts to include Indigenous Peoples’ practices and methods

⁴ See: Results in chapter 3 of the IPBES Values Assessment, Section 3.2.4. Valuation practice in Indigenous Peoples and local communities’ contexts. <https://zenodo.org/records/7701879>

around valuation of nature. However, something was lost, because the worldviews, spirituality and core values were not easily incorporated within conventional disciplines and ways of representing knowledge.

A participant also highlighted the lack of an emotional element in the draft scoping report, explaining that some Indigenous Peoples may want to “feel” the landscape and changes within it, particularly regarding conservation and protection of their ways of being. For example, knowing that their plants will be protected and not taken advantage of, e.g., by corporations, can be an important feeling when Indigenous Peoples are out on the land. If this emotional element is not brought into the scoping report, there is a risk that the assessment will be a surface-level exploration, without a true understanding of what Indigenous Peoples are asking for from nature conservation and cultural continuity. Some Indigenous Peoples want “western” academics to recognize that plants are spiritual beings, that people have a relationship with. Identifying language that enables this is therefore important.

Another participant raised an issue with some of the terms and metaphors used in the scoping report, where biodiversity conservation is presented by using metaphors from machines, such as “impacts”, “pressures” and “drivers”. It could be beneficial to use other metaphors, including organic terms. Examples for biological terms included, “catalysts of transformation” rather than “drivers of change”. Similarly, “impacts” could be expressed as “reverberations” or “repercussions”. Discussions of “pressures” and “drivers” could also consider “burdens”. However, as discussed above, participants noted that the second global assessment should go beyond this to find metaphors to explain the worldviews and relationships of Indigenous Peoples and local communities, as they often speak of being in family, relationship, and kinship with the land. Finding a common language also enables a reflection on differences, for examples, while some groups speak of “protecting”, other Indigenous Peoples would not use this term, for example in Australia.

Participants therefore noted that one key task for the second global assessment (and for future work of the platform in general) is to work out how different worldviews and frameworks can be inclusively represented in a dialogue among different worldviews and knowledge systems, moving beyond integrating elements or certain terms in the conceptual framework. To support this, participants suggested that building broader participation, with elders and knowledge holders directly engaged in framing core conceptualizations, including in the scoping of future assessments, would be beneficial.

3.3.3. Indigenous and local languages

Participants noted that the second global assessment should highlight and explore the importance of the revitalization and preservation of Indigenous and local languages, given their important links with ILK and the links between language diversity, cultural diversity and biodiversity, particularly in the framework of the UN Decade on Indigenous Languages. A

participant noted that there are many international legal instruments that highlight the importance of Indigenous Peoples, their knowledge, and their role in the protection of biodiversity and the fight against climate change. However, many multilateral agreements (e.g., the Paris Agreement and the Nagoya Protocol)⁵ do not mention Indigenous languages. Participants therefore agreed that the second global assessment should explore the links between ILK and language. Participants noted that this could be a focus of the second chapter.

Participants also noted that the assessment could aim to address recurring language gaps in IPBES assessments, including the predominance of sources in English, and English or majority languages as the main modes of expressing concepts. This challenge is also evident at the community level, where uptake of IPBES reports also depends on language. They noted that the second global assessment could therefore provide space for a deeper exploration of concepts and sources in diverse Indigenous and local languages. However, a participant noted that the conceptual gap might persist, given that authors often rely on written materials, which is very different from how Indigenous Peoples and local communities share and explore knowledge. While the dialogue workshops are a starting point to address this, they are limited in impact and thus this issue will remain a barrier.

3.4. Chapter 2: Indigenous and local knowledge

3.4.1. Why a chapter focused on Indigenous and local knowledge?

There was clear agreement among participants of the ILK dialogue workshop that a chapter solely focused on Indigenous and local knowledge would be important and beneficial. Participants noted that this would show IPBES's commitment to transformation and inclusivity within its work. This would also provide an important space for a deeper analysis of multiple knowledge systems, and to explore the conceptual frameworks and linguistic issues discussed in the above section, as well as performing a thorough analysis of Indigenous Peoples' rights relevant to the scope of the assessment through the lens of UNDRIP. They also noted the need for this additional focus on ILK, considering that all recent IPBES assessments have highlighted significant gaps in knowledge around ILK and Indigenous Peoples and local communities, which the chapter could seek to begin to address. Participants noted that this should be considered a good practice for subsequent assessments, with the full chapter of the second global assessment as a starting point for further enhancing work with ILK and participation by Indigenous Peoples and local communities.

⁵ *Nagoya Protocol on Access to Genetic Resources and the Fair and Equitable Sharing of Benefits Arising from their Utilization (ABS) to the Convention on Biological Diversity*

They also noted that the ILK chapter should be the second chapter, as proposed in the draft scoping report, as in this way the chapter can set out a framework, concepts, worldviews, language, themes and priorities that can flow through the rest of the assessment.

3.4.2. Connections throughout the assessment

However, participants also noted a risk that ILK could become siloed in an individual chapter. For example, a participant noted that in Colombia's National Ecosystem Assessment, a key achievement was the inclusion of a chapter on biocultural diversity, which focused on ILK and Indigenous Peoples and local communities.⁶ However, the ILK content was concentrated in this chapter, and the assessment as a whole would have benefited from a clearer guiding thread to connect it with the other chapters.

Participants emphasized that the challenge for the second global assessment will thus be to connect the ILK chapter with the entire assessment, and to ensure that ILK is accorded equal value alongside science throughout the report. Participants noted that the language in the draft scoping report suggests there might indeed be a risk of missing these connections, as other chapters (including the chapter on ILK) are framed in scientific terms. Furthermore, later chapters suggest a rather cursory consideration of ILK and issues related to Indigenous Peoples and local communities or suggest that knowledge brought by Indigenous Peoples and local communities might inform options regarding their own challenges, rather than influencing broader policy options and management actions. Participants therefore recommended that a clear vision on how to mainstream ILK throughout the whole assessment is needed. This vision should include how to articulate links between chapters and how chapters subsequent to the chapter on ILK should refer back to its findings.

Related to this, many participants raised concerns that the scope of chapter 2 as given in the draft scoping report seems too ambitious, and might be covering too many topics, with the chapter ranging from conceptualizations through to trends and policy options. They therefore suggested that chapter 2 could focus mainly on exploring the diversity of Indigenous Peoples and local communities and their worldviews and how these relate to conservation of nature and sustainable use of resources. Other aspects could be transferred to other chapters, further ensuring the consideration of ILK throughout the assessment. Threats, pressures, challenges and resulting trends could be discussed in chapter 3 on status and trends, whereas policy options relating to ILK and Indigenous Peoples and local communities could be taken up in chapter 5. They further noted that the word limit indicated for the chapter suggests that these changes in chapter scope would prove beneficial.

⁶ See The Colombia National Ecosystem Assessment, chapter 4 - Biocultural diversity: knowledge and practices for taking care of life in Indigenous Peoples and local communities' territories, available at: <http://repository.humboldt.org.co/handle/20.500.11761/35993>.

3.4.3. Participation and authors

Participants noted that special consideration for institutional arrangements will be needed to support a full chapter on ILK, to avoid siloes and to ensure its successful consideration throughout the second global assessment.

Participants noted that it will be crucial to select authors with appropriate expertise and knowledge for the chapter on ILK. Authors should preferably be members of Indigenous Peoples and local communities, and reflect the diversity within these groups, i.e., including Indigenous scholars, women, youth and, as much as possible, elders. The aim should be representation across communities. In previous assessments, it has been difficult for Indigenous Peoples and local communities to participate as authors, given the time requirements, a focus on English as the working language, connectivity issues and other constraints. The assessment may need to place more consideration on how to overcome these issues.

Additionally, authors with relevant expertise and knowledge, including Indigenous scholars, will be needed in all other chapters, particularly as co-chairs and coordinating lead authors, so that ILK is considered throughout the entire assessment. A strong ILK liaison group across all chapters will be essential to support this, which would also help to avoid redundancy and overlap. Chapter 2 authors could also become contributing authors for other chapters to enhance cross-chapter work. Experts who are not Indigenous Peoples and local communities from other chapters could also be involved in chapter 2, to foster knowledge co-production and dialogue.

For this reason, participants agreed that a clear understanding should be developed among IPBES members on the nominations required for the appropriate expertise to be included in the expert team, noting that often government nominations do not include Indigenous Peoples and local communities or people with ILK expertise. A participant also noted that it would be important to have Indigenous authors from different regions, including from each of the seven regions recognized by the UN Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues (UNPFII), which might be hindered by the funding framework of IPBES.

In terms of process, participants noted that the chapter on ILK could contribute to enhancing Indigenous Peoples and local communities' contributions in other ways as well. For example, the work on the chapter could be an opportunity to bring elders or knowledge keepers together to shape a framework that is more attuned to Indigenous worldviews and knowledge systems, as discussed above in section 3.2.2, which in turn might facilitate working with ILK throughout the assessment. Considering how to ensure diverse contributions using different modes of participation outlined in the IPBES Approach to ILK would be important.

A participant further noted that it is important to recognize and clearly acknowledge that many Indigenous Peoples and local communities will not share all of their knowledge with IPBES, as much of their knowledge is confidential, or as it cannot be explained to outsiders or written down. Many Indigenous Peoples and local communities may also only provide information that

they believe fits the IPBES framework, which can also limit what is shared. There are therefore some limitations as to what chapter 2 and the second global assessment can contain in relation to ILK.

Participants also noted a challenge in that conventional disciplines do not train researchers on how to work with ILK. Many authors who participate in IPBES assessments might therefore not have a workable understanding on ILK and Indigenous worldviews. The second global assessment, however, presents an opportunity to promote and elevate mutual understanding between different worldviews and knowledge systems. Allocating time for a training on ILK for authors before they begin with the preparation of the chapters would therefore be beneficial. A complementary strategy could be the engagement of young Indigenous scholars or other scholars as part of the technical support unit, since they are often highly knowledgeable about Indigenous epistemologies and knowledge systems.

3.4.4. Methods and approach

Participants recommended the use of Indigenous methodologies for data collection and analysis, as these can gather credible information related to ILK within the philosophies and value systems of Indigenous Peoples and local communities. Such methodologies are also integral to the ways that Indigenous Peoples manage and relate to biodiversity, including management and restoration of forests and rivers. Specific Indigenous methodologies and related concepts were offered as examples of what should be considered in the second global assessment, including a method for passing on knowledge developed by the Yucatec Maya called *Tsikbal*, which includes discussing, storytelling, experimentation and confirmation in situ. Oaxacan Indigenous scholars have also proposed concepts of communality and interculturality which relate to the ways in which communities manage their territories. Thus, the assessment should aim to explore and use such methodologies by gathering relevant information and, crucially, by consulting and working with Indigenous scholars.

In terms of the overall approach of the second global assessment, participants also noted the importance of aiming for co-production of knowledge, and that application of FPIC and oversight by Indigenous Peoples and local communities will be essential.

Participants also recommended that the ILK dialogue workshops for the assessment should be held in community settings. Meetings in big urban centres or online can limit what can be shared, while community settings enhance mutual learning, respect and reciprocity with all manifestations of life and among participants, and facilitate practical observation of community protocols and use of Indigenous approaches in daily life, in close connection with nature. Allocating enough time for the planning of these workshops is important, as well as for working with local partners. Allocating enough time for the workshops themselves is also essential, so that there is enough time for knowledge sharing and for participants to form connections with each other and the location. Additionally, ILK dialogues in communities can help to overcome

language barriers and facilitate the participation and contributions of ILK holders who preserve oral traditions and experiential learning in the land. Participants noted that recognizing and respecting Indigenous lands and traditional methods of knowledge transmission with the workshops is crucial in creating an environment where genuine dialogue can thrive.

Finally, participants recommended that it would be useful to detail activities in the assessment timeline related to work with ILK, such as deadlines for Indigenous authors nominations, any reviews planned with members of Indigenous Peoples and local communities, and requests for case studies.

3.4.5. Topics for chapter 2 on Indigenous and local knowledge

Participants noted that it has been proven that there is often greater biodiversity on territories under Indigenous control and governance. They also noted that traditional practices often enhance ecosystems or even create new ecosystems. Given this, participants highlighted that chapter 2, and the assessment as a whole, should consider how Indigenous Peoples and local communities' concepts, worldviews and values discussed above translate into their ethical and sustainability principles. This includes understanding how these come to underpin guidelines and rules that inform how Indigenous Peoples and local communities interact with nature, as well as their practices which lead to enhanced and protected biodiversity.

As discussed above, participants noted that many of these concepts, principles and rules may be encoded in Indigenous and local languages, and informed by generations of ILK, so attention to these will be essential. In particular, chapter 2 should include an analysis of methods for transmitting and continuing ILK. For example, in the Ngimurok community in Kenya, medicine men and women are trained from youth to know different plants and traditional uses for food, local medicine, and preservation practices.

Participants further noted that customary governance systems and institutions and social relationships are also crucial in terms of the interrelationships between worldviews, values and practices that enhance and protect biodiversity, and that these too should be explored.

For all of the above considerations, participants emphasized that exploring and highlighting the diversity between and within Indigenous Peoples and local communities will be key.

A participant also noted that the consideration of biodiversity should include Indigenous Peoples and local communities' practices around and contributions to agrobiodiversity, as this was not analysed in detail in the first Global Assessment. The participant emphasized the need to focus also on genetic diversity, as well as the inclusion of information relevant to the Nagoya Protocol and digital sequencing. Including this in the second global assessment could increase its impact,

as a review of progress on this agreement was agreed at the CBD's Subsidiary Body for Scientific, Technical and Technological Advice (SBSTTA) and Subsidiary Body for Implementation (SBI).⁷

Participants also noted that it would be important to highlight and explore how the actions of Indigenous Peoples and local communities around biodiversity in its different forms are an important contribution to the achievement of global goals, including the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework and the Sustainable Development Goals. Other participants agreed and highlighted that many Indigenous Peoples and local communities have stressed the importance of recognizing “people’s contributions to nature,” as well as “nature’s contributions to people”, noting this as a missing factor in the IPBES conceptual framework. Meanwhile, others noted that this conceptual gap still enforces a division between nature and people, which many Indigenous Peoples and local communities do not experience in their own worldviews and knowledge systems. Nonetheless, participants agreed that examining and highlighting Indigenous Peoples and local communities’ contributions to conservation and sustainable use, and the mechanisms for this, would be important, including diverse case studies.

Participants noted that all of these points underscore the importance of recognizing the critical relationship between nature and culture in the assessment, especially considering nearly 30 years of exploring biocultural approaches, including through UNESCO and the CBD.

3.4.6. The title and framing of chapter 2

Participants also discussed the title of the chapter. They noted that the title can be crucial to ensure that the chapter is not dismissed by readers, as there may be prejudice about the significance of ILK for the full report. Thus, the title should indicate that this chapter sets the conceptualizations that inform other parts of the report.

Some participants also noted that including the term “Indigenous Peoples and local communities” in the title would broaden its scope beyond just knowledge, as is suggested by a title only using “Indigenous and local knowledge”, to encompass broader issues related to people and Peoples, such as agency, actions and rights. Some participants noted that a focus only on knowledge can mean that the people that hold the knowledge are less visible in the narrative. A participant also noted that much ILK is created within systems that are not visible, for example by learning through experience on the land rather than in formal settings. A focus is therefore needed on how knowledge is created, as it is important to highlight these systems in order to identify paths for supporting them.

Other participants, however, preferred that the title focuses on knowledge, in part due to the tensions around the term “Indigenous Peoples and local communities” that are discussed above

⁷ See [recommendation 4/11](#) adopted at the fourth meeting of the SBI (21 to 29 May 2024, Nairobi, Kenya), based on a [note](#) by the Secretariat.

in the section on terminology. They also noted that for many groups, knowledge is highly important, and as the chapter will draw from ILK, then the title could focus on ILK.

Another participant also suggested that a title or framing could be “Interlinkages between biological and cultural diversity, a framework for recognizing contributions of Indigenous and local knowledge systems” again recognizing that ILK exists within broader contexts and includes relations between nature, of which people are an integral part.

3.5. Chapter 3: Status, trends, drivers and impacts

Participants noted that an exploration of trends, drivers and impacts will be important for the assessment. However, they noted that while the draft scoping report focuses on “drivers”, it is crucial to also give attention to indirect drivers, which can include deeper aspects of values, relationship and ethical obligations in how people live with nature, including how people perceive good quality of life.

It was also emphasized that the second global assessment should include information on conflicts that impact nature and Indigenous Peoples and local communities, including the killings and harassment of environmental defenders. Participants noted that in the Saweto case, four Indigenous leaders were killed, and the communities waited nine years for a final sentence to be given. Other cases were shared, where 37 Indigenous leaders who defended their ancestral territories and biodiversity were killed. Participants emphasized that such cases of violence and human rights violations, which lead to destruction of communities and nature, need to be highlighted by the international community. The dispossession of Indigenous Peoples and local communities from their lands can also become a significant driver of biodiversity loss, as Indigenous Peoples and local communities can then no longer protect and manage the land. This should therefore be explored in terms of its impacts on people and nature. Another participant added that it is also necessary to include information about the protection mechanisms needed and the penalties that could be applied as a result of these human rights violations.

Participants further recommended that impacts relating to extractive industries and dams should be analysed, including those funded by international financial institutions, in turn recognizing that the private sector is a major driver of biodiversity loss. Participants noted cases in all parts of the world, where community protests against the construction of a dam, for example in Asia, were dismissed, and the dam was built despite environmental concerns. The second global assessment could examine these conflicts, in particular examining the environmental impacts of projects that went ahead despite concerns. This would strengthen and support Indigenous Peoples and local communities who are raising environmental concerns. Examples could also include large-scale mining operations that damaged rivers and vital resources for many communities, while violating human rights, and that are still operating without necessary

safeguards. Examples could further include biofuel plantations that not only took lands from smallholders but also brought in invasive species that impacted the farming systems of nearby Indigenous Peoples and local communities. A participant also noted that illegal mining, drug trafficking, illegal deforestation for oil palm cultivation, land trafficking, illegal logging and corruption of public agencies are also a threat to Indigenous Peoples and local communities and the conservation of biodiversity, for example in parts of the Amazon.

Participants also asked that mountains and oceans be included in this analysis, noting that in relation to oceans the potential impacts of relevant international agreements and treaties should be analysed.

Participants also noted significant knowledge and action within Indigenous communities and local communities, and among their organizations and networks, which can drive positive change. For example, Indigenous Peoples in Peru are working on the protection of life in their ancestral territories and to mitigate climate change impacts through the Regional Organization “*Asociación Interétnica de Desarrollo de la Selva Peruana*” (AIDSEP). These efforts could be highlighted and explored. However, participants also noted that there is significant knowledge and potential in communities which is not yet supported or utilised to benefit communities, nature and the world, partly due to the risks of violence and human rights violations as described above. They therefore noted that full application of UNDRIP and human rights would be a significant positive driver of biodiversity and human-wellbeing that should be explored.

A participant also noted that care is needed around the term “trade-offs”, including clarifying who is making the decisions around trade-offs. Indigenous Peoples’ values often get pushed aside in such discussions, despite them often experiencing greater impacts. Additionally, the scale at which trade-offs are being considered is important, because at the local level, elements can be irreplaceable and essential, while they are disregarded or considered an acceptable “trade-off” at other levels.

3.6. Chapter 4: Future pathways

Regarding chapter 4 on future pathways, participants noted that IPBES has worked on joint activities bringing together Indigenous Peoples and local communities to discuss future visions, pathways and scenarios.

Participants recommended that a future scenario could include full application of UNDRIP and human rights, and what this would mean for nature, Indigenous Peoples and local communities and the world.

A participant also suggested that the assessment could explore diverse Indigenous principles and customary governance systems, as well as biocultural pathways centred on Mother Nature. This

could allow an exploration of socio-cultural, linguistic, ritual, spiritual and reciprocal relationships with Mother Nature and Earth, as well as how to incorporate new technologies, practices and innovations from ILK for humanity. Participants noted that within these discussions, it will also be essential to acknowledge traditional spirituality and ways of worship as part of a shared vision for biodiversity.

3.7. Chapter 5: Options for action

3.7.1. Policymaking and institutions

It was suggested that as well as addressing policies, chapter 5 should also address bureaucracies, institutions and procedures, as they can all be significant drivers of negative impacts on people and nature, or barriers to positive change.

Participants noted that clearer implementation guidelines are needed at the government level to make them accountable for creating and implementing policies that support assessment findings, with participation from Indigenous Peoples and local communities. Thus, transformative change in the way policy is designed and implemented is necessary, along with connections to other processes at international and local levels. The assessment could explore these important challenges and propose ways forward.

3.7.2. Rights

There was a strong agreement among participants that human rights and Indigenous rights as set out in UNDRIP should be central to the policy options in the second global assessment, noting that Indigenous Peoples are entitled to distinctive collective Indigenous rights, not only to individual human rights. Current international standards established through UNDRIP and other international instruments recognize various rights such as land rights or collective rights to ancestral territories; the right to distinctive ways of life; the duty to consult; the process of FPIC; and collective intellectual property rights, among others. Notably, the right to self-determination is crucial for strengthening Indigenous governance systems that enhance biocultural diversity conservation and sustainability.

Participants also recommended that the assessment should propose a policy strategy that includes support for environmental defenders, who are often harassed or face violence and human rights violation, as this is a crucial issue for many Indigenous Peoples and local communities and their lands.

Participants also highlighted that dispossession of Indigenous Peoples and local communities is an important driver of biodiversity loss, as discussed above. Currently, “green colonialism” is a significant concern in the context of the implementation of the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework, as a new push for protected areas and green energy may encourage

governments to move Indigenous Peoples and local communities off their lands. A focus on how to achieve the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework goals and targets while respecting land rights and enhancing land tenure for Indigenous Peoples and local communities would therefore be important.

A participant noted that while previous assessments highlighted the need to recognize rights, there has been some resistance from governments to discuss the topic. They noted also that IPBES is tasked with providing options without being policy prescriptive. However, it was noted that the summaries for policymakers could have stronger messages, to clearly state that Indigenous Peoples and local communities' human rights and Indigenous rights are obligations, not options, and as such, they should not be pushed aside. In this sense, when discussing rights in IPBES assessments, these should be portrayed as obligations that member states of the United Nations are committed to protect and uphold. Moreover, these rights are now recognized by the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework. In this context, an analysis of pathways for how UNDRIP and human rights could be implemented and how this would support the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework would be valuable, recognizing that pathways may differ between countries and contexts, depending on the diversity of Indigenous Peoples and local communities, ecosystems, national governance and so on. For instance, in Fiji, group rights have been gradually accepted, whereas these rights were previously rejected because they did not qualify as individual proprietorship. Participants also highlighted rangelands and access rights as an example. Another participant noted that these rights should also be explored through the lens of regional agreements such as the Escazu Agreement.⁸ This focus should encompass various forms of justice, including socio-economic, cultural and ethical, while addressing gaps in the distribution of benefits and burdens, with the aim of providing policy guidance to governments, companies, and conservation organizations, among others.

Participants noted that independent protection mechanisms are needed for Indigenous Peoples and local communities, as often governments fail to safeguard these communities and their rights.

Participants also raised the topic of rights of nature, highlighting the importance of not excluding people within discussions of nature's rights. Another participant noted that while "rights of nature" may sound like an approach that coincides with the worldviews of Indigenous Peoples and local communities, in reality, it often enforces the idea that nature is a separate element with no people and can be used to justify exclusion of people from landscapes. For example, a recent judicial decision in Colombia (STC 4360 of 2018, Colombian Supreme Court) recognized the Amazon region as a natural entity entitled to rights, but overlooked the Indigenous Peoples who own and live in more than 50% of the Amazonian territory. While the ruling recognized the

⁸ Regional Agreement on Access to Information, Public Participation and Justice in Environmental Matters in Latin America and the Caribbean

rights of urban children and future generations, it neglected the rights of Indigenous children whose ancestors not only lived in harmony with, but also nurtured, the Amazon. Thus, participants considered that the concept of “biocultural rights”⁹ could help to better embrace the interrelationships between communities (their values, languages and ways of living) and nature (such as rivers, mountains and lakes), while acknowledging that humans are part of nature, and that nature and human beings nurture each other. A participant noted that a Yucatec Maya expression gives a perspective on this concept: “We nurture nature because nature nurtures us”.

3.7.3. Learning and continuity of knowledge and values

Participants also highlighted the importance of support for the continuation and revitalization of ILK knowledge systems, including languages, worldviews, values and practices. They noted that many aspects of their knowledge are ancestral, and represent a transmission and adaptation of knowledge over many generations, and that this transmission must also be protected. They also noted that it is essential that Indigenous Peoples and local communities do not lose their capacities and abilities to create and innovate new knowledge around how to protect biodiversity and human wellbeing.

Participants also noted that while many ILK systems are still functioning well, others are suffering dramatic declines and disruptions. Crucially, the transmission of ILK from generation to generation may often be declining. The second global assessment should therefore highlight the urgency of halting the loss of ILK, and explore options for action. Diverse options for halting this loss and supporting ILK systems were suggested, as discussed below. The second global assessment could explore these options.

Some participants recommended introducing ILK into education systems to ensure that ILK is preserved and protected, and that Indigenous Peoples and local communities’ values are

⁹ Some suggested references regarding biocultural rights were provided:

- Nemogá, G. R., Appasamy, A., & Romanow, C. A. (2022). *Protecting Indigenous and Local Knowledge Through a Biocultural Diversity Framework*. The Journal of Environment & Development, 31(3), 223-252.
- Nemogá-Soto G. and Amaris-Álvarez A. (2023) “Los protocolos comunitarios bioculturales y su papel en la autodeterminación y autonomía en las comunidades étnicas”. Revista Etnobiología. Vol 21, Núm. 2. pp: 139-159. <https://revistaetnobiologia.mx/index.php/etno/article/view/551/494>
- Chen, C. W. and Gilmore, M. (2015) *Biocultural Rights: A New Paradigm for Protecting Natural and Cultural Resources of Indigenous Communities*. International Indigenous Policy Journal. Vol. 6 No. 3. <https://doi.org/10.18584/iipj.2015.6.3.3>

maintained through schooling.¹⁰ Participants noted that there is currently no mechanism to ensure ILK continuity through education.

Others noted the potential benefits of establishing directories of traditional knowledge at the local and national levels, establishing national ILK databases, and documenting and codifying traditional knowledge to share it at the national level, with a view to restoring it at local levels. This could include focusing on ILK related to biodiversity conservation and climate change mitigation and adaptation and conduct practical field studies in collaboration with ILK holders.

However, other participants noted that it is important to recognise and support the ways that ILK is transmitted from one generation to another in communities, and the ways in which Indigenous Peoples and local communities learn, create, innovate and transmit ILK outside of formal education systems. For example, this is often done on the land with elders, in a context where some learning is through seeing, some through practice, and some through listening. A way forward could therefore include governmental support to integrate these traditional practices with formal schooling systems, so that pupils can learn from elders in their own communities. Participants noted that currently, knowledge is often extracted from communities, and then subsequently a representation of this knowledge is then presented back to learners at schools, including learners who are not from the community in question. It would be more beneficial for learners to spend time in their communities and on their lands to learn within the knowledge system. A participant shared an example of how work has been done to explore and make visible the ways through which Maya peoples in Mexico learn and thus create knowledge. This in turn inspired the academic higher education of the *Universidad Intercultural Maya de Quintana Roo*, Mexico.¹¹

Beyond this, a participant also noted that it may be necessary to carry out studies on how to strengthen the capacity of Indigenous Peoples and local communities to maintain their ILK, working with knowledge holders in the field and recognizing that different communities will face different strengths and challenges, for example loss of lands and species, evictions, violence or changes in values due to external education systems.

A participant also noted that the status and perception of ILK systems would also need to be enhanced. Often, ILK is considered informal or un-authoritative, while science has occupied educational systems and has become the formally recognized knowledge on the lands of Indigenous Peoples and local communities. ILK is not certified in school, and there are no

¹⁰ For an example of this, see Francisco J. Rosado-May, Valeria B. Cuevas-Albarrán, Francisco J. Moo-Xix, Jorge Huchin Chan, and Judith Cavazos-Arroyo (2018) Intercultural Business: A Culturally Sensitive Path to Achieve Sustainable Development in Indigenous Maya Communities. In. Handbook of Engaged Sustainability. S. Dhiman, J. Marques (eds.). Springer International Publishing AG.
https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-53121-2_32-1

¹¹ See: Rogoff, B. (2014). Learning by observing and pitching in to family and community endeavors: An orientation. *Human Development*, 57(2-3), 69-81.

certificates that show someone's ability to manage the land. Changing the status of ILK could further support the motivations of learners and educational systems to give attention to ILK. These are all challenges that the second global assessment could explore.

Linked to this, participants noted that research and work is also needed to explore how young people today consider themselves as members of Indigenous Peoples or local communities, including their relationships with territory, how they defend lands, how they take care of the environment, and, crucially, how this is influenced by new ideas and values from outside of their communities and knowledge systems. An example could be an exploration of the significance of pushing Indigenous Peoples and local communities to use specific agriculture practices, noting that technological agricultural policies and measures introduced by governments or research institutions often push aside ancestral practices that are coherent with the worldviews of Indigenous Peoples and local communities, food self-sufficiency and the environment. For example, some communities in Mexico have stopped growing milpa and instead engage in corn monoculture, which changes values, knowledge systems and agriculture practices. While their Yucatec Maya ancestors understood milpa, new generations only understand agriculture through new technologies and models.

Additionally, another participant highlighted the need to consider holistic and dynamic relationships of Indigenous Peoples and local communities with nature and Mother Earth alongside the above-mentioned technical considerations, including their interrelationships with nature, their practices and their impacts at local scales which cumulatively have global significance.

Participants also emphasized that ILK systems could be better supported and valued through their inclusion in national legislation and national plans and through creating monitoring and evaluation committees at the national level, including representatives of Indigenous Peoples and local communities. Action at an international level can also be important to explore, including the preparation of an international database of ILK related to biodiversity and climate change and its continuous monitoring, as well as exchange of information between the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change and CBD secretariats and respective parties. Participants also noted that it could be beneficial to highlight initiatives where Indigenous Peoples and local communities' contributions to nature have been implemented and supported through multilateral environmental agreements.

3.7.4. Customary governance

Participants emphasized the importance of customary governance for Indigenous Peoples and local communities.

A participant noted that many Indigenous Peoples and local communities would like to cooperate and partner with governments and others, but on equal terms. They noted that many Indigenous Peoples and local communities do not want to only participate in specific events, processes or

research projects. They instead want to run their own governance and management systems in their territories. They noted that this is part of the right to self-determination, which is a crucial goal for many Indigenous Peoples as enshrined in UNDRIP. However, there has been a long struggle for full and effective participation in discussions about the control of their lands and territories.

Participants, however, noted that recent scientific findings, including those of the first Global Assessment indicate that the territories where full governance by Indigenous Peoples and local communities is in place are usually areas with high and well-conserved biodiversity both in lands and waters. Therefore, customary governance systems should be recognized, and cooperation with them should be direct, in order to fully exercise their rights.

Participants recommended that the second global assessment should deepen the first Global Assessment's discussion of customary governance, including its links with knowledge, philosophies, values and spiritual and cultural connections to the land and Mother Earth, and importantly, its contributions to biodiversity conservation and human wellbeing.

Participants emphasized that it will be important to explore and provide options for ways to better support and revitalize customary governance systems, in part by restoring and supporting knowledge systems and by enhancing respect for customary governance, similarly to knowledge systems as described above. Successful case studies in Mexico, such as the Ejido San Crisanto in Yucatán, or in Noh Bec, Quintana Roo, could be incorporated as examples, as they offer valuable insights into effective policy options.

A participant noted that the first Global Assessment also presented information regarding the effectiveness of official systems and national policies for protecting nature, revealing that in contrast to customary governance systems, formal systems are often ineffective or contradict the governance systems of Indigenous Peoples and local communities, leading to problems and power imbalances. Another participant noted that international and national policies related to health, education, economy, agriculture and biodiversity conservation at the local level have impacted the ways of life of Indigenous Peoples and local communities, contributing to the loss of their cultural identity, as seen in the Amazon region. Participants therefore emphasized that it will be necessary to explore ways that national policy and frameworks can be adapted to better support and collaborate with customary governance systems, for mutual benefit.

3.7.5. Intellectual property rights

Participants highlighted that the second global assessment should address issues related to intellectual property and sharing of benefits in national legislations, and analyse the past, present and future risks of biopiracy affecting ILK, biodiversity and nature, noting that in many countries, ILK is not registered as intellectual property.

A participant noted that it is important to explore the co-optation of ILK by states and non-Indigenous businesses, which often leads to the creation of economic pathways that do not support Indigenous Peoples. An example is the concept “Indigenous agriculture” that is being used in Australia. These processes can create an institutional spiral that begins as a discourse based on a decision to use ILK for a product, and then the terminology becomes commonly used for processes and products that are increasingly divorced from the Indigenous Peoples themselves, and the process ends in Indigenous Peoples losing control and the ability to derive financial or other benefits at the local level. To address this, the second global assessment could look for new language and findings to explain and articulate the co-optation of ILK, recognizing how language itself can facilitate this process.

Additionally, the assessment could analyse the effectiveness of the Nagoya Protocol in relation to biopiracy, including by pharmaceutical companies, researchers and governments. Participants noted that while the protocol is a valuable tool, more work is needed to ensure that it fulfils its goals in ensuring benefits to Indigenous Peoples and local communities. The case of the Olotón corn variety was given to illustrate this issue. This variety, which can fix nitrogen through aerial roots, is of interest to a company and universities as it may reduce the needs for fertilizers. They have lightly followed the Nagoya Protocol by obtaining permission from the government and local people. However, the process had gaps in ensuring fairness and it seems that the communities are not going to benefit from the potential of the discovery, even though they have been managing and nurturing this corn variety for centuries. If researchers can genetically modify bacteria from this corn and insert them into other species, the discovery may no longer be considered the intellectual property of the Indigenous communities.¹²

A participant also noted that an international judicial framework may be needed to ensure the appropriate use of ILK.

3.7.6. Monitoring and indicators

Participants highlighted that the proposed section on monitoring should include indicators developed by Indigenous Peoples and local communities, including biocultural indicators developed in different contexts with the participation of Indigenous Peoples and local communities, which could be found in recent publications on biocultural indicators.

3.7.7. Finance and funding

Participants noted that financing is a crucial issue for Indigenous Peoples and local communities. In particular, they highlighted the need for direct funding to Indigenous Peoples and local communities. They noted that currently funds are often directed through governments, NGOs or

¹² See Kloppenburg, J, et al. 2024. The Nagoya Protocol and nitrogen-fixing maize: Close encounters between Indigenous Oaxacans and the men from Mars (Inc.). *Elem Sci Anth*, 12: 1. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1525/elementa.2023.00115>

other actors, with limited results, or they are used for projects that have negative impacts on nature and communities. Direct funding to Indigenous Peoples and local communities can ensure that the people who are on the ground conserving biodiversity are adequately supported, including for activities such as Indigenous Peoples and local communities' land and water stewardship, guardianship, managing communal forests, Indigenous protected and conserved areas (IPCAs), and similar initiatives. Moreover, some participants further noted that Indigenous Peoples in developed countries such as Canada also require significant financing to steward their biologically diverse territories, and should therefore not be overlooked in these discussions. Participants recommended that the second global assessment should explore the need for direct funding to Indigenous Peoples and local communities, and also the mechanisms by which this could occur, including through Indigenous Peoples and local communities' representative organizations.

Participants also highlighted that the funding committed should be long-term and reliable, to ensure that biodiversity is safeguarded in a meaningful and sustainable way, as short-term funding can have limited results.

Participants also noted that funding should be directed to protect Indigenous Peoples in isolation and initial contact and to better support cultures at risk of extinction.

A participant also explained that there are concerns within the work of the Taskforce on Nature-related Financial Disclosures, around investment in biodiversity and how to manage full participation of Indigenous Peoples. The second global assessment could also explore these issues.

Participants also highlighted that nature and carbon markets are often considered a good solution in climate discussions, but they are often unacceptable to Indigenous Peoples and local communities. Therefore, the relationship between climate action and biodiversity action and their impacts on Indigenous Peoples and local communities need careful consideration. Participants noted that concepts of "nature-based solutions" held by governments and others can vary widely, and these might not align with perspectives of Indigenous Peoples and local communities on how nature can be a solution. It is therefore necessary to be careful about the language used to translate the ideas of Indigenous Peoples and local communities into options for action that are framed in a different worldview, to avoid misinterpretations.

3.7.8. Structure

In terms of the draft structure for chapter 5, participants noted that the chapter's scope may be too large. A participant proposed that the first two sections, which focus on learning from the past and providing insights on lessons learned for the future, be moved to a separate chapter, as they do not provide options for action. This restructuring could allow chapter 5 to focus on presenting a portfolio of actions, including monitoring and financing, as these are concepts that relate to each other.

Additionally, as discussed above for chapter 2 on ILK, participants noted that the proposed ILK policy option section in chapter 2 should instead be part of chapter 5, so that it is an integral part of the overall policy options from the assessment.

3.8. Dissemination and implementation

Participants agreed that IPBES assessments present important results that could become tools for enforcing human rights and Indigenous rights and addressing a range of issues at the local level. However, they noted an ongoing challenge in results reaching the local level. They noted that governments and national institutions have a responsibility to disseminate the findings, and that multiple actors, including governments, institutions and communities should be actively and openly discussing the results, particularly at the community level. If this occurred, Indigenous Peoples and local communities would be able to better benefit from the assessments.

A main recommendation for IPBES was therefore to prioritize the dissemination of results and support implementation where possible. Participants also emphasized that the second global assessment and IPBES should include policy support activities that engage with Indigenous Peoples and local communities and their governance systems.

4. Next steps

A series of steps took place after the workshop:

- A series of comments for the external review period were developed from the dialogue. These were sent to participants for editing and approval, and following this they were submitted into the formal review process;
- Using the comments as a resource, the team of scoping experts continued to develop the draft scoping report for the second global assessment;
- A report from the dialogue workshop (this report) was developed. The draft report was sent to all participants for them to edit, make additions, and/or approve prior to finalization and publication online;
- The scoping report for the second global assessment will be considered by the IPBES Plenary in December 2024; and
- Pending Plenary approval, the second global assessment will commence in 2025.

Annexes

Annex 1: Agendas

Session 1: 8am-11am Paris time

Time	Session
8am-8.15am	Welcome / introductions
8.15am-8.20am	Objectives of the workshop, FPIC
8.20am-8.25am	IPBES, Indigenous and local knowledge, and Indigenous Peoples and local communities
8.25am-8.35am	Introduction to the second global assessment
8.35am-8.45am	Overview of ILK/Indigenous Peoples and local communities in first Global Assessment and other assessments
8.45am-9.45am	Discussion: • Highlights and benefits from previous assessments? • Gaps and weaknesses in previous assessments? • How can strengths and progress be built on for the 2nd global assessment? • What do Indigenous Peoples and local communities want to see from a second global assessment? • Which processes or aspirations could this support?
9.45am-9.50am	Break
9.50am-10.05am	Review of ILK in IPBES: challenges and ways forward. Structure and contents of the assessment in draft scoping report. Opportunities and challenges of a separate ILK chapter
10.05am-10.55am	Discussion: • Comments on the scoping report contents and structure • ILK chapter: ways forward • Methods for the second global assessment • Connections between chapters • People and resources
10.55am-11am	Next steps and closing

Session 2: 4pm-7pm Paris time

Time	Session
4pm-4.15pm	Welcome / introductions
4.15pm-4.20pm	Objectives of the workshop
4.20pm-4.25pm	IPBES, Indigenous and local knowledge, and Indigenous Peoples and local communities
4.25pm-4.35pm	Introduction to the second global assessment
4.35pm-4.45pm	Overview of ILK/Indigenous Peoples and local communities in first Global Assessment and other assessments
4.45pm-5.45pm	Discussion: • Highlights and benefits from previous assessments? • Gaps and weaknesses in previous assessments? • How can strengths and progress be built on for the 2nd global assessment? • What do Indigenous Peoples and local communities want to see in the second global assessment? • Which processes or aspirations could this support?
5.45pm-5.50pm	Break
5.50pm-6.05pm	Review of ILK in IPBES: challenges and ways forward Structure and contents of the second global assessment in its draft scoping report Opportunities and challenges of a separate ILK chapter
6.05pm-6.55pm	Discussion: • Comments on the scoping report's contents and structure • ILK chapter: ways forward • Methods for the second global assessment • Connections between chapters • People and resources
6.55pm-7pm	Next steps and closing

Annex 2: Free, Prior and Informed Consent document

Indigenous and local knowledge dialogue workshop for the scoping of the second global assessment

Online, 5 June 2024

The individuals whose names are listed at the end of this report agreed during the dialogue workshop to follow the principles and steps laid out in this document.

Background

Within the framework of the UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP), principles of Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) apply to research or knowledge-related interactions between Indigenous peoples and outsiders (including researchers, scientists, journalists, etc.). Given that the dialogue process includes discussion of Indigenous knowledge of biodiversity and ecosystems, there may be information which the knowledge holders or their organizations or respective communities consider sensitive, private, or holding value for themselves which they do not want to share in the public domain through publications or other media without formal consent.

Principles

The dialogue will be built on equal sharing and joint learning across knowledge systems and cultures. The aim is to create an environment where people feel comfortable and able to speak on equal terms, which is an important precondition for true dialogue.

To achieve these aims, the following goals are emphasized:

- Equality of all participants and absence of coercive influence
- Listening with empathy and seeking to understand each other's viewpoints
- Accurate and empathetic communication
- Bringing assumptions into the open

If participants feel that the above goals are not being achieved at any point during IPBES activities, participants are asked to bring this to the attention of the organizers of the activity, or the IPBES technical support unit on ILK, at: ilk.tsu.ipbes@unesco.org.

Sharing knowledge and respecting Free, Prior and Informed Consent

To ensure that knowledge is shared in appropriate ways during dialogue workshops and other IPBES activities, and that information and materials produced after these activities are used in ways that respect FPIC, we propose the following:

Guardianship – participants who represent organizations and communities

- Principles of guardianship will be discussed with participants at the beginning of IPBES activities.
- Participants who represent organizations or communities will act as the guardians of the use of the knowledge and materials from their respective organizations or communities that is shared before, during or after the workshop. Any use of their organizations' or communities' knowledge will be discussed and approved by the guardians, as legitimate representatives of their organizations or communities. Guardians are expected to contact their respective organizations and communities when they need advice. Guardians are also expected to seek consent from their organizations or communities when they consider that this is required, keeping in mind that sharing details of their community's knowledge can potentially have negative consequences, for example sharing the locations and uses of medicinal plants.

FPIC rights during dialogue workshops and other activities

- The FPIC rights of the Indigenous Peoples participating in dialogue workshops or other activities will be discussed prior to the beginning of the activity, until participants feel comfortable and well informed about their rights and the process, including the eventual planned use and distribution of information. This discussion may be revisited during the activity, and will be revisited at the end of dialogue workshops once participants have engaged in the dialogue process.
- Participants do not have to answer any questions that they do not want to answer, and do not need to participate in any part of an activity in which they do not wish to participate;
- At any point, any participant can decide that they do not want particular information to be documented or shared outside of the activity. Participants will inform organizers and other participants of this. Organizers and participants will ensure that the information is not recorded. Participants can also request that the information is only recorded as a general statement attributed to a region or country, rather than to a specific community.
- Permission for photographs must be agreed prior to photos being taken and participants have the right not to be photographed. Organizers will take note of this.

After the activity

- Permission will be obtained before any photograph of a participant is used or distributed in any form.
- Permission will be obtained before any list of participants is used or distributed in any form.

- Participants maintain intellectual property rights over all information collected from them about themselves or their communities, including photographs. Their intellectual property rights should be protected, pursuant to applicable laws.
- Copies of all information collected will be provided to the participants for approval.
- Any materials developed for IPBES assessments or other IPBES products using information provided by participants will be shared with the participants for prior approval and consent.
- The information collected during the activity will not be used by IPBES for any purposes other than those for which consent has been granted, unless permission is sought and given by participants. However, IPBES does not have control over how others may use its publicly available materials that may contain ILK.
- Participants can decline to consent or withdraw their knowledge or information from the process at any time, and records of that information will be deleted if requested by the participant. Participants should however be aware that once an assessment is published it cannot be changed, and information incorporated into the assessment cannot therefore be withdrawn from the assessment after this point.

Annex 3: Participants of the dialogue workshop

Indigenous Peoples and local communities		
Name	Country	Affiliation
Wilfredo Alangui	Philippines	University of the Philippines Baguio / IPBES ILK task force
Myrle Ballard	Canada	Environment and Climate Change Canada/ IPBES ILK task force
Ramiro Batzin	Guatemala	Co-Chair, International Indigenous Forum on Biodiversity
Joji Cariño	Philippines	Forest Peoples Programme / IPBES ILK task force
Adelaido Corcino Martinez	Mexico	Instituto Superior Intercultural Ayuuk
Florence Daguitan	Philippines	Tebtebba
Kriss Davies	Grenada	Civil society partner to Grenada NEA
Sandra C.A. Ferguson	Grenada	Co-chair on the Co-ordinating Team re the Grenada National Ecosystem Assessment
Mohamed Handaine	Morocco	Center for Amazigh Historical and Environmental Studies
Guadalupe Yesenia Hernandez Marquez	Mexico	International Indigenous Forum on Biodiversity
Aslak Holmberg	Finland	Saami Council
Maui Hudson	New Zealand	Associate Professor of Māori and Indigenous Studies at Waikato University
Ramson Karmushu	Kenya	Indigenous Movement for Peace Advancement and Conflict Transformation (IMPACT)
Lynn Jacobs	Canada	Indigenous Leadership Initiative
Pius Loupa	Uganda	African Wildlife Foundation / IPBES ILK task force
Gathuru Mburu	Kenya	African Biodiversity Network
Lucy Mulenkei	Kenya	Co-Chair, International Indigenous Forum on Biodiversity
Gabriel Nemogá	Colombia	Research Group PLEBIO-Universidad Nacional de Colombia, University of Winnepeg
Kamal Kumar Rai	Nepal	Indigenous Knowledge and Peoples Network Society for Wetland Biodiversity Conservation (FIKA)
Miri Raven	Australia	University of New South Wales (UNSW)
Francisco J. Rosado-May	Mexico	Universidad Intercultural Maya de Quintana Roo
Nick Roskrige	New Zealand	Maori horticultural collective Tahuri Whenua / IPBES ILK task force
Ndiaga Sall	Senegal	Enda Santé
Cecilio Solís Librado	Mexico	Presidente de la Federación Indígena Empresarial y Comunidades Locales de México
Viacheslav Shadrin	Russia	Chief, Council of Yukaghir Elders
Laitia Tamata	Fiji	University of the South Pacific
Prasert Trakansuphakon	Thailand	Pgakenyaw Association for Sustainable Development (PASD)
Yeshing Upun	Guatemala	Asociacion Sotz'il
Geronimo Vega	Peru	Regional Organization of “Asociación Interétnica de Desarrollo de la Selva Peruana” (AIDSESP) Ucayali (ORAU)

Scoping report authors		
Zühre Aksoy	Turkey	Bogazici University
Myrle Ballard	Canada	Environment and Climate Change Canada
Eduardo Brondizio	Brazil	Indiana University Bloomington
Ricardo Castro-Díaz	Colombia	National University of Colombia
Laura German	USA	University of Georgia

IPBES ILK task force		
Wilfredo Alangui	Philippines	University of the Philippines Baguio
Myrle Ballard	Canada	Environment and Climate Change Canada
Joji Cariño	Philippines	Forest Peoples Programme
Adriana Flores	Mexico	IPBES Multidisciplinary expert panel
Catherine Febria	Canada	IPBES Multidisciplinary expert panel
Guadalupe Yesenia Hernandez Marquez	Mexico	International Indigenous Forum on Biodiversity
Ethel Kamba	Malawi	Environmental Affairs Department, Ministry of Natural Resources and Climate Change
Paulina Karim	Russia	National Dong Hwa University/ Forestry and Nature Conservation Agency
Pius Loupa	Uganda	African Wildlife Foundation
Nick Roskrige	New Zealand	Maori horticultural collective Tahuri Whenua
Peter Bates	UK	Technical support unit, UNESCO

